Set 1:

Instructions: Welcome to your experiment! You will read some passages and answer some reading comprehension questions about them. Press SPACE to continue.

Mind wandering is a term used to describe what occurs when your attention wanders from a task. Sometimes when your mind wanders, you begin thinking about personal events or concerns rather than your task. At other times, your mind can wander because you are bored or tired and you don't really know what you're thinking about; all you know is that you are no longer thinking about your task. Press SPACE to continue.

To ensure accuracy, please read each passage carefully.

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A few had been astute enough to see a fine poet in Browning, and Elizabeth Barrett was one of them.

The young man with the lemon-colored gloves and long dark hair and high-strung, restless manner who had visited her in 1846 had been moved to write to her because she had praised his poetry.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

She found the man even more to her liking than the verse, and it was not so very long-only the time between May, 1845 and September, 1846-before Robert Browning had stolen the poetess from the dour father who guarded her like a dragon (never wanting her to marry any man), and taken her with him to Italy and a new life.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

One morning, soon after their nuptials, Elizabeth Browning thrust a manuscript into her husband's pocket, and then scampered upstairs in a swift confusion to her room.

Written during the time of their courtship and love missives, it was a sonnet sequence on their love.

These poems were never intended by Mrs. Browning to be published, but her poet husband promptly declared that they must be.

The Sonnets from the Portuguese was his suggested title—a title which might shroud the fact that they were personal.

They were in his mind "the finest sonnets written in our language since Shakespeare's."

Sonnets from the Portuguese, in Browning's opinion, was hardly more flattering to his wife than his opinion of most of her poetry.

A better poet than he, thought Browning, and the world at that time agreed with him.

He called her his “moon of poets,” as she considered him her sun.

She was a pure singer with a lovely lyrical tenderness, the best poet of her sex since Sappho.

Her Sonnets, in their autobiographical candor, in their fine restraint and fullness, reveal a woman’s secret soul as had no other poetry in our literature up to that time.

Her lyrical mastery shines in many passages of her writings.

Italy was a kind of promised terrain for Elizabeth Browning.

Living in Florence or in little villages in the summers, she drank in the sun of the south and warmth of her husband’s love, and blossomed in a life of precarious happiness for fifteen years.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

In Italy she found friends, most of them cultured Americans.

Hawthorne saw the Browning's there: the New England thinker and essayist Margaret Fuller visited them.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

The painter Story came, and the young sculptress Harriet Hosmer.

One caller records that Robert Browning was “simple, natural, and playful,” and that Mrs. Browning was all “genius and sensibility.”

Daytimes Browning walked forth with Elizabeth's little dog Flush, but he seldom could be lured from his home evenings.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

One privileged intruder, coming frequently at night to join the poets over hot chestnuts and mulled wine, found talk good and laughter plentiful.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

During the third year of their stay in Italy, a son, Robert Weidemann Browning, was born.

But through this happy life a strain of dark foreboding began to creep.

Elizabeth Browning’s father died unrelenting in his disavowal of her marriage, refusing to see her or to sanction any of his family to see her.

Three children all younger than her own boy were left to her by a dearly beloved sister who died.

She drooped and pined a little and Browning shielded her from ordinary visitants.

She had a sudden and alarming attack of indisposition but was not considered in any precariousness.

One night, soon after, she awoke from a troubled slumber and, apparently with no idea that she was about to leave him, murmured in the tenderest fashion of her love for him, and in his arms her head drooped as though in a faint, but it was the end.

Profound and lasting was Browning's grief. “Looking back,” he said, “I see that we have been all the time walking over a torrent on a straw.”

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

1. Flush was the name of the Brownings’

a. cat.

b. dog

c. canary

d. turtle

e. thrush

2. At night the Brownings often enjoyed

a. hot chestnuts

b. a tart with clotted cream

c. strawberries and cream

d. café au lait

e. cheese soufflé

3. The Brownings saw

a. Coleridge

b. Byron

c. Walt Whitman

d. Poe

e. Hawthrone

4. Browning wrote to Miss Barrett because she had

a. invited him to visit

b. written him for advice

c. praised his poetry

d. sent him one of her own poems

e. sent a friend to meet him

5. The authors of this passage placed most attention on the Brownings'

a. literary efforts

b. personal relationship

c. social contacts

d. problems

e. early meeting

6. What best describes the Brownings' early days abroad?

a. travel

b. relaxation

c. creative activity

d. intellectual stimulation

e. happiness

7. You would assume that Browning

a. found it easy to see Elizabeth

b. carefully avoided Mr. Barrett

c. begged Mr. Barrett's consent to marry

d. understood Mr. Barrett

e. got Elizabeth to ask her father's consent

8. In the “torrent on a straw” quotation, the word straw probably refers to

a. the frailty of life

b. weakness of character

c. sorrow

d. happiness

e. the fleeting nature of fame

Marketing is a business activity that directs the flow of goods and services from a producer to a consumer or user.

It is the link that connects producers and consumers and brings production and consumption together.

About one in every six employees is involved directly in wholesaling or retailing activities.

This ratio does not take into account other employees who assist marketing through transportation, communication, and office jobs.

Marketing provides many different kinds of jobs.

These jobs require a wide range of skills and abilities.

We usually think that the primary job in marketing is selling, but there are jobs in management, advertising, market and product research, and buying.

The economic well-being of our country is determined largely by productivity, consumption, and employment.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p for NO.

The efficiency of marketing affects all three.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p for NO.

People consume many goods if marketing creates a demand.

High consumption requires high productivity to meet the wants of people, and high productivity and high-level activity in marketing combined result in high employment.

Marketing is indirectly a key to a high economic level of living for the people.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

1. Our economic well-being is determined largely by how many factors?

a. one

b. two

c. three

d. four

e. five

2. One major factor mentioned as affecting our economic well-being was

a. high wages

b. low interest rates

c. technology

d. employment

e. foreign trade

3. The purpose of this passage is to

a. persuade

b. guide

c. evaluate

d. inform

e. interest

4. The chief emphasis is on

a. defining marketing

b. principles of marketing

c. opportunities in marketing

d. kinds of jobs in marketing

e. the economic significance of marketing

Atomic energy is the energy that holds the nucleus of an atom together.

Atomic reactions in which nuclei of helium are built up from nuclei of hydrogen are believed to be the origin of the sun's energy.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

It has been found that the mass of an atomic nucleus is less than the total mass of the separate particles that comprise it.

The reason is that when a nucleus forms, part of the mass of the component particles is changed into energy, which is then radiated away.

The quantity of energy released in reactions of this kind is almost inconceivably greater than the quantity released by any other type of reaction involving similar quantities of material.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

Every second, a million times as much energy as is stored in all our coal, petroleum, and natural gas fields is sent into space by the sun.

If one could duplicate the method by which this energy is released, the world could be revolutionized.

And the possibility of doing just this is no more inconceivable today than the concept of an atomic bomb was in 1900.

The time may come when the hydrogen from a cubic mile of sea water will provide enough energy to satisfy our needs at the 1960 rate for 300 centuries.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

1. How much sea water was mentioned?

a. One ton

b. A cubic acre

c. A cubic mile

d. A thousand gallons

e. A hundred tons

2. The quantity of energy released in an atomic reaction is spoken of as how much greater than with other types of reactions?

a. Far greater

b. Unbelievably greater

c. A thousand times greater

d. Inconceivably greater

e. Tremendously greater

3. The primary focus is on

a. how energy is released

b. where energy is found

c. the energy from atomic reactions

d. what happens in atomic reactions

e. the energy present in sunshine

4. This passage is best described as

a. objective

b. skeptical

c. cautious

d. conservative

e. optimistic

The possibility of life on Mars is not dismissed even by skeptics.

They seem to share our hope that it is true.

So, it was disappointing when scientists studied photos from the early Mariner space flights in the mid-1960's.

They saw no canals, no seas, and no busy Martian engineers.

They saw no dangerous, warlike Martians as huge as skyscrapers.

All they saw were mountains, craters, cold winds, and dust storms.

It was almost as if scouts for Columbus had returned to Isabella's court with the news that the world had turned out to be flat after all.

Hopeful astronomers reminded us that the Mariner IV had photographed a mere one percent of the Martian surface from 2,000 miles away.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

In addition, the photos were taken from 2,000 miles away.

And they pointed out that the Earth-orbiting Tiros weather satellite shot over 20,000 pictures before uncovering any evidence of life on Earth.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

But still, public enthusiasm for Martian exploration wilted.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

Few people seemed to care about life on Mars by the time Viking I landed on the Plain of Chrise in August.

One Viking scientist, J. Richard Keefe, said that he was "disgusted" at the "blasé...apathetic" public response and the skimpy television coverage of one of the most magnificent scientific and technical accomplishments in human history.

1. One weather satellite was named

a. Latos

b. Tiros

c. Prometheus

d. Sonar

e. Satelos

2. One of the Mariners photographed how much of the surface of Mars?

a. One percent

b. Two percent

c. Three percent

d. Four percent

e. Five percent

3. Interest in Mars diminished largely because

a. no Martians were found

b. the TV coverage was poor

c. the photos were all black and white

d. nothing was brought back to earth

e. the media did not appreciate the accomplishment

4. Mention of the flat world was used to point up

a. the flatness of Mars

b. the lack of canals

c. the lack of seas

d. the lack of Martians

e. the lack of mountains

The flavor, odor, and character so highly prized by the gourmet is given to cheese by fungi.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

In caves near the French village of Roquefort was first found one such mold. A peasant boy left his lunch, a mild fresh piece of goat cheese, according to legend, in one of these caverns and on returning found it marbled, tart, and redolent.

Only cheeses from the area around these particular caves are permitted to bear the name of Roquefort.

As early as the seventeenth century, ergot, the fungus of rye, was used to facilitate childbirth.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

The contraction of the involuntary muscles, particularly of the uterus, is one of its effects.

In the twentieth century, ergot has once more attracted interest as the source of the chemical from which the hallucinogenic drug LSD is derived.

Most of the modern antibiotics are produced by fungi.

The first of these was discovered by Alexander Fleming, who noted that a mold of the genus Penicillium which had contaminated a culture of staphylococcus growing on a nutrient agar plate had completely halted the proliferation of the bacteria.

Antibiotics, of which many hundreds have now been discovered, are substances produced by a living organism that injure another living organism.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

1. A fungus was used as medicine as early as what century?

a. Sixteenth

b. Seventeenth

c. Eighteenth

d. Nineteenth

e. Twentieth

2. How many antibiotics have been discovered?

a. Ninety-six

b. Many hundreds

c. Thousands

d. Millions

e. An unspecified number

3. This passage is mainly about

a. ergot

b. drugs

c. fungi

d. antibiotics

e. cheese

4. LSD is specifically mentioned to show that ergot

a. needs to be further controlled

b. needs further research

c. has medicinal value

d. is of current interest

e. is dangerous

Local governments were our first governments.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

A local government was established when the oldest men in a primitive tribe formed a council and the tribe chose a chief.

The tribe was seeking a better, safer life.

In the same way, the first English settlers soon realized that they needed rules and leaders after they landed at Jamestown, Virginia in 1607.

At first, the settlers had to look out for themselves.

They searched for gold, and had to find their own food and provide their own shelter.

As food supplies began to run low, and as the colonists faced hunger and disease, they saw that they needed to work together if the colony was to survive.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

So, they needed to work together if the colony was to survive.

The colonists formed a council to make laws for the colony.

They chose Captain John Smith as president of the council.

His job was to see that the laws were carried out.

This government at Jamestown was the first local government in America.

Today, local government is still the first and most important one in our lives.

It protects our lives, our safety, and our homes, and it helps to keep our environment clean.

Local government provides us with schools, libraries, and other important services.

1. The first colonial government was

a. tribal

b. city

c. county

d. local

e. federal

2. The Jamestown colonists formed a government because of

a. pride

b. greed

c. necessity

d. togetherness

e. public spirit

3. The best title for this selection would be

a. John Smith

b. The First Government

c. Jamestown

d. Local Government

e. American Government

4. The overall goal of local government seems to be public

a. regulation

b. wealth

c. growth

d. welfare

e. protection

Once in a while you will hear about an artist recognized as a master during his own lifetime but then almost forgotten soon after his death.

A good example is the painter Domenicos Theotocopoulos, known because of his Greek ancestry as El Greco.

After pursuing his early career in Italy, El Greco settled in the Spanish city of Toledo, where he prospered for the rest of his life.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

But after his death, El Greco was forgotten by history for nearly three hundred years, until he was rediscovered by artists and critics of the twentieth century.

The power of El Greco's intensely emotional style can be felt most strongly in his later canvases, such as the famous View of Toledo painted in 1610, only a few years before death.

One notices in this strange landscape how the eerie, silvery buildings take on a ghostlike stillness next to the explosive light of the sky and the writhing forms of the countryside below.

Curiously enough, another important artist of about the same time was scorned even by many of his own contemporaries.

This artist was Caravaggio, a self-taught painter who had come to Rome around 1590 from a small town in Lombardy.

Caravaggio's critics complained that he treated exalted religious subjects in a low, vulgar style, because he included in his paintings the faces and figures from the street of common people.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

By using stark contrasts of light and shadow, Caravaggio managed to conjure up unforgettable scenes of dramatic realism.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

1. In his paintings, Caravaggio included

a. common people

b. strange landscapes

c. eerie, silvery buildings

d. ghosts

e. corpses

2. El Greco pursued his early career in

a. Italy

b. Greece

c. Lombardy

d. Rome

e. Toledo

3. Apparently a major technique of Caravaggio's was

a. using exalted religious subjects

b. using stark contrasts

c. using cadavers

d. using ghostlike stillness

e. none of the above

4. The principal idea discussed in this passage concerns

a. El Greco

b. Caravaggio

c. contemporary approval of artists

d. the travels of painters

e. the prosperity of artists

Random assignment is the key to experimental design.

Random assignment insures that the results of experiments are not influenced by some extraneous variable.

An extraneous variable is one that is correlated with the variable under investigation.

In contrast, correlational designs allow subjects to assign themselves to conditions.

Thus, in the cancer studies as they have been done, only people who are four-pack-a-day smokers—by their own "choice"—get into a four-pack-a-day condition.

But, the factors that make people four-pack-a-day smokers must surely make them different from typical nonsmokers in other ways.

Hence the ambiguity of interpretation in correlational designs, and hence the virtue of experimental designs.

Differences among individual subjects cannot systematically confound the results if assignment to conditions is truly random.

Put another way, the experimenter has under his control all the variables that can influence the results.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

It is another question as to whether they can exactly identify these variables.

Thus, the results from experimental designs are not entirely unambiguous, but they are less ambiguous than the results from correlational designs.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

1. Specific mention is made of

a. psychogenesis

b. psychodynamics

c. psychobiology

d. psychotherapy

e. none of the above

2. How many research design patterns were discussed?

a. only one

b. two

c. three

d. four

e. five

3. As used in this passage, the phrase “put another way” means

a. rephrasing

b. enumeration

c. using details

d. reasoning

e. illustration

4. In this passage, the authors imply that heavy smoking is probably caused by

a. tension

b. nervousness

c. habit

d. social pressure

e. all the above and more

You will now complete part 2 of the study.